

app being used currently and is highly popular across all ages. Besides, there is no character limit and there is the added option of sending audio or video messages.

Rare pink, a diamond ring manufacturer has used WhatsApp for customer engagement. It not only offers customers an opportunity to interact with design artists through WhatsApp but also allows direct, unfettered access between customers and staff members. Rare Pink also sends videos and pictures through WhatsApp so customers can get a detailed overview of the final product and the material that will be used. It has led to quicker response times and some bulk orders for the firm. It's a bit ironical indeed that the messaging app that was built as a grunge response to advertisement relying social sites would one day become such an important tool for advertisers.

Telegram is another messaging app that has seen an upsurge in user base over a short period of time. Founded by Russian siblings Pavlov and Nikoali Durov (founders of VK, the Russian equivalent of Facebook), it offers a greater degree of encryption than other similar apps. Telegram is used regularly by the BBC and the Pope. Telegram offers bots that can handle automated responses.

Bot service can be utilized effectively by taxi booking apps, florists, restaurant owners and other service providers for marketing. Some airlines are already using the automated bot service for better customer engagement. Once a ticket is booked, the bot guides you through the rest of the process. Imagine you wish to book a pizza from an online delivery service. Would you prefer going through the cumbersome process of booking one after downloading the correct app, registering yourself as a user, then authenticating it... Phew! Or would you rather chat with a bot inbuilt on your messaging app?

ChatBot

Chatbots can mimic natural individual human interactions and will be the next big thing in marketing. However, the recent public fiasco with Microsoft's artificial intelligence chatbot Tay shows that the technology is still nascent and requires a bit of R&D before it can be fully utilized. However, not all chatbots are based on artificial intelligence and are easier to develop than a fully functional app. They can come in useful for setting up calls, reminders to consumers about their monthly payment or recharge cycles or for collecting valuable feedback. Bots could be used to offer concierge